

Case Management System – SQL: Missing Next Court Date Query

Overview:

This query retrieves active cases from Case Management System that have no next court dates to support data hygiene projects.

Attorneys rely on the next court date field for proper scheduling of caseloads. When an error occurs, through data entry or otherwise, the data needs to be corrected in CMS.

The query uses various logical tests and gives CMS users a recommendation on where to search and update the information. All data is filtered for active cases with missing next court date, no disposition, and in criminal defense practice. The filter for case appearance date range is customizable.

The user should verify with various sources, i.e., UCE, WebCrims, NYCIS, DOCCS, etc. and update the missing fields where appropriate.

The table below describes the logical tests, the recommended search actions, and the reasoning.

Logical Test	Recommendation	Reason
If UCE disposition is Dismissal or Guilty Plea.	Check for disposition from the court calendar or NYCIS. Check for consolidation/ covered.	Case likely ended. Verify with NYCIS or other sources. It's also likely covered by another case.
If CMS latest case appearance is AFTER the UCE's latest appearance date.	Check NYCIS, WebCrims, etc. for more information.	UCE is not aligned with CMS. Need more information.
If CMS latest case appearance is BEFORE the UCE's latest appearance date and the UCE's date is AFTER today. And if there are active indictment numbers.	Use UCE's date, check with WebCrims, NYCIS, etc. Check for consolidation under an indictment number.	The case is active with an upcoming court date validated in UCE. It may also be consolidated under an active indictment number.
If CMS latest case appearance is BEFORE the UCE's latest appearance date and the UCE's date is AFTER today. And if there are no active indictment numbers	Use UCE's date, check with WebCrims, NYCIS, etc.	The case is active with an upcoming court date validated in UCE. It still may be consolidated, or covered by an existing docket.
If CMS latest case appearance is BEFORE the UCE's latest appearance date and the UCE's date is BEFORE today.	Check Disposition, NYCIS, court calendar for more information	CMS is more outdated than UCE, but more information is needed to determine the case's status.
If CMS latest case appearance is EQUAL to UCE's latest appearance date	Check NYCIS, WebCrims, etc. for more information. See if cases need to be consolidated, closed, etc.	CMS and UCE are aligned, but more information is needed to determine the case's status.

IF UCE latest appearance date is NULL	Check NYCIS, WebCrims, etc. for more information.	UCE has no information, search other sources like NYCIS, WebCrims, etc.
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General Instructions: Once the next court date is confirmed, through NYCIS or other sources, enter it into the appropriate fields in LawManager and be sure to update other important items such as judge, next court part, action, etc..

The following are a list of sources that CMS users can access to update the missing information.

- NYCIS – General case lookup, should be the default tool in searches.
- [WebCrims](#) – Use only for active cases.
- [DOCCS Lookup](#) – Useful if the client is in on bail or incarcerated.
- OCA Calendar Emails in Outlook – Use for dismissed or sealed cases that are not in NYCIS.
- Court Data Feed – Used for general information, but may have errors.
- [Organization Employee Lookup](#) – useful for confirming LAR, attorney transfer, cases.

Common Issues:

There may be some underlying pattern that explains how these data errors happen. However, such observations don't apply to every case, and each case must be examined individually.

Case Consolidation

When a client has multiple active cases and has been indicted, those cases are often consolidated under a single indictment number. Currently, CMS has no protocol for handling such consolidations. For now, note the consolidated cases in the *Description* box in the matter table and enter *Consolidated* in the Appearance tab, Action field.

Under the *Recommended Checks* column, these cases will usually be labeled as 'UCE Updated: Active case - use UCE date/check consolidation'.

To prevent duplicate case entries for the assigned attorney:

- Make a note (e.g., using “covered by” or another disposition) once the case ends to indicate consolidation in the worksheet.
- Check the following column indicators which suggest cases should be consolidated:
 - **active_case_count** greater than 0
 - **consolidate_indictment** flag (indicates the client may have an indicted case suitable for consolidation)
 - **matter_stage** is ‘Transfer_SC’
 - **Recommended Checks** will indicate ‘UCE date/check IND consolidation’

Additionally, it is possible to cross reference the charges with UCE. For example, for indictment number **IND-####-26**, which has 5 cases consolidated under one indictment but is not indicated in NYCIS.

- Use the charges and the dates to cases in CMS to verify if those are supposed to be filled in even if UCE doesn’t list the charges.
- The charge in **214.50(3) criminal contempt** with an incident date on **1/20/23** in the arrest tab matches the line in UCE, suggesting that it’s been consolidated into that indictment number.

Until a formal system is in place, here are some rules of thumb regarding consolidated cases:

- For instances where one of the cases stop receiving UCE appearance updates, those should be marked as consolidated and closed out.
- Occasionally, the UCE court dates may jump around among the open cases due to one-to-many matches in the ETL process. Whichever receives the most up-to-date should remain open and the rest would be closed.

- If multiple cases receive UCE updates at the same time, leave it until one of the cases drops out, since a determination cannot be made and it might alter the case for the attorney.
- If the case can't be confirmed with NYCIS, leave it open unless, absolutely certain. Even cases where the dockets numbers are sequential to each other might be treated as two cases sometimes. Be careful until there is clarity.

Active but Disposed Cases

A client with multiple cases may have multiple dockets covered by a disposed case. These cases are not necessarily guilty pleas or dismissals but are covered by a final disposition of a separate, usually consolidated, case. The CMS user should close the case by selecting the appropriate *Action* under *Case Appearances*.

Under the *Recommended_Checks* column will indicate 'UCE Disposed: Check Final Dispo/Covered/NYCIS'.

- Under Action in Case Appearances, select **Covered**.
- Check the following column indicators which suggest cases should be consolidated:
 - The **U_appearance_outcome** column should indicate 'Covered by'
 - **U_docket_dispo_category** will usually be labeled as 'dismissed'
 - **Recommended Checks** column will suggest 'UCE Disposed: Check Final Dispo/Covered/NYCIS'

Case Relieved

When a client is transferred to a different defense attorney, e.g., 18B counsel, updates from UCE appear to be halted. There is no definitive flag for how these cases may appear in CMS or in the No NCD query aside, other than the lack of updates from UCE. These cases need to be closed out through *Action* under *Case Appearances*, where CMS users can select LAR.

- CMS Users should confirm with NYCIS or WebCrims that the case is LAR.

- The employee lookup page can be used to confirm whether the assigned attorney is from the organization or not.

Duplicated Docket Numbers

Ideally, each docket number in CMS should be unique. Due to data entry error, duplicate docket numbers can be created which causes problems with record keeping and receiving updates from OCA and UCE. These records cannot be deleted on the front end.

Currently, the best practice would be to close out the case by filling in the date closed field with the date that is in the date opened field. This should close out the case and minimize confusion.

For questions please email Erwin Ma